

Nokia E51 A Classic Reborn

If you are an executive in the market for a suitable cell phone, Nokia's E series offers the best bang for the buck. The Nokia E51 is the latest from the venerable E series, and an apt successor to the hugely popular E50 model, which it will eventually replace. The E51 brings in new features at a price that's hard to beat.

The keypad is completely revised, with dedicated keys for Contacts, Calendar, E-mail and Home. The soft menu keys, however, are too small for comfort. The rest of the keypad is a delight—good tactile feedback, and key spacing is immaculate. The rubberised keys for volume up / down, push-to-talk and power are hard to operate, though.

The E51 feels peppy—it uses the same processor as

on the flagship N95. With 130 MB of memory on board, you can do a lot of multitasking without the phone getting sluggish, and the memory can be expanded to 4 GB via the microSD slot (a 512 MB card comes bundled). The E51 runs on Symbian OS Series 60, and crams in lot of features besides the standard set. Most of these will go down well with executives—for example, the Advance call manager lets you manage incoming and outgoing calls efficiently. In addition, WorldMate, an application for frequent fliers, comes bundled.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



The E51 is a 3G, quad-band phone with HSDPA, Wi-Fi (802.11g), Bluetooth, Micro USB and an infrared port. There's a switch to turn Bluetooth on and off on the main keypad. Multimedia features include a good MP3 player, a 2MP camera with

still and video shooting, and FM radio.

Signal reception is good, as is voice clarity. Internet browsing speeds are faster than with the E50 or E61, thanks to the revised Web browser. The camera is above average, but loses performance in low-light conditions. The speakerphone is clear, with little or no echo on the recipient's side. We got around three days of battery life with nominal usage and a terrific seven days of standby time.

The Nokia E51 retails at Rs 14,699; it is, we think, a must-buy.

Specifications

Weight: 100 gm; Dimensions: 114 x 46 x 12 mm; Quad-band; 2MP camera; Video recording; XHTML browser; Push-to-talk; micro USB, infrared.

Contact: Nokia India Pvt Ltd
E-mail: ext-manoj.goel@nokia.com
Web site: www.nokia.co.in
Price: Rs 14,699

Creative Zen Stone Plus 2GB A Pebbleful Of Music!

With Apple launching a whole new range of iPods recently, including the iPod Touch, can Creative afford to be far behind? Not one to be caught shuffling around (pun intended), Creative has launched the Zen Stone Plus series.



With a player so tiny, we'd expected the Zen Stone to feel flimsy, but surprisingly it didn't. There's a small circular blue OLED screen—nothing special—and a Play button surrounded by a circular button that houses four controls—track shuffle and volume up / down. There's a tiny button on the top of the player that has controls for the Menu and play / pause functions.

Available in 2 GB only, the Zen Stone features FM radio and supports up to 32 presets, inbuilt audio recording, and a stopwatch function—not bad for such a small device. Unlike iPods, there are no drivers required to connect it to your PC—just drag and drop, which is a huge relief.

Music quality is a mixed bag with the Stone. Firstly, if you're even remotely interested in good sound, throw away the bundled earplugs. Once we replaced them with our Creative EP630 headphones, everything was so much clearer. Then we tried the Bose Intra Ear—our reference for PMPs—and things seemed even better. Punchy, tight bass, superb vocal tones, and a decent extended high-end makes the Zen Stone very suitable for

RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

rock, pop, jazz and reggae. If you listen to lot of classical music, you'll need much better headphones to bring out the recessed highs. Bottom-line: the Zen Stone is only limited by its default earplugs—and most PMPs are.

Don't let this stop you buying it—if you want something tiny, sturdy, and easy to use, the Zen Stone will suit you. If you want good sound, invest in a pair of decent in-ear earplugs.

Specifications

Capacity: 2 GB; Battery life: 9.5 hrs; Display: 64 x 64 blue OLED; Weight: 21 gm; Audio support: MP3, WMA, Audible, WAV

Contact: IDLDPL
Phone: 011-46096400
E-mail: contactus@idldpl.com
Web site: <http://in.creative.com>
Price: Rs 4,399

CoolerMaster Real Power M1000 Never Run Out Of Juice

CoolerMaster is a big name in the Desktop chassis and PSU market, and there's nothing small about the Real Power M1000, either. CoolerMaster goes modular with this model, which cuts down on cable clutter. A 135 mm fan dominates the underside of the unit and cools well.

With the dedicated circuitry that active PFC features, this PSU is rated at 99 per cent—you can be assured of maximum efficiency of power distribution, a good thing for those high-end PCs with costly components.

We fired up a Core 2 Quad QX6850 on an ASUS P5N32-E SLI and

overclocked it to 3.6 GHz, powered the 2 GB of 1066 MHz memory at 2.2 V, two 8800GTX in SLI, two WD Raptors in RAID 0 plus a third 500 GB hard drive, and an X-Fi Elite Pro along with a couple of DVD-Writers.

The M1000 handled everything with no fuss—it remained cool to the touch, supplying 3.31 V to the 3.3 V rail, 4.97 V to the 5 V line and 11.987 V to the 12 V line—perfectly

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



acceptable and well within the boundaries of what's considered *really* good.

If you're looking for power for the kind of PC that gets geeks drooling, you should know that such power supplies don't come cheap! But if the safety of your components matters and you can shell out Rs 15,600, then you can't get anything better.

Specifications

Power (continuous): 1000 watts; Efficiency: >85%; Input voltage 90-264V (auto); Peak power to each rail: 3.3V: 40 amps, 5V: 40 amps, combined 12V rails: 110 amps

Contact: CoolerMaster Co. Ltd.
Phone: +91-9833870302
E-mail: tanmay_i@coolermaster.com
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 15,600

ASUS Maximus Formula CrossFire Compadre

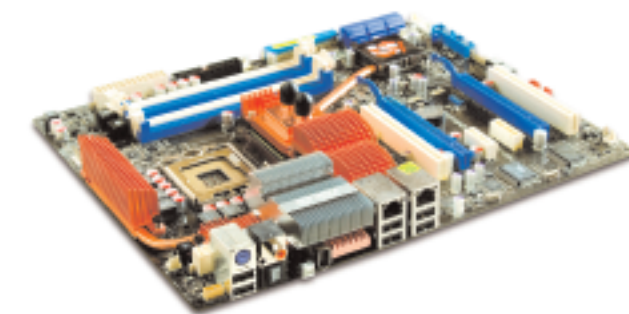
This one comes as an overclocker's delight. The ASUS Maximus Formula is based on Intel's new X38 chipset, sporting an ICH9R Southbridge. This is a limited edition, and features hand-picked components for extreme overclockability.

There is support for Penryn and 1600 MHz FSB, and dual x16 slots that officially support CrossFire. Incidentally, the PCI-E slots support the new PCI-E 2.0 standard too—more future-proofing for you. ASUS drops in their fusion block system as well—basically a heat-pipe solution that integrates a water block on the Northbridge chipset for proper cooling. The entire board has a very intricate heat-pipe system that remained cool no matter how hard we thrashed it.

Some nifty little additions will appeal to overclockers: the CMOS,

Power and Reset buttons, and colour-coded LEDs on the PCB that will display the status (whether overvoltage or not) of components including CPU, memory, Northbridge, and FSB. There's also an inbuilt sensor that will warn you if GPU temperatures exceed a set threshold—a boon for users with the latest thermal monsters from NVIDIA and ATI. ASUS has also incorporated a 2-phase memory voltage termination for better voltage regulation even while overclocking—this should filter noise and RF interference for better performance under stress. The BIOS is full of

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★



overclocking options and tweaks—newbies and enthusiasts alike will feel at home.

The Maximus Formula SE also has a more-than-sufficient number of SATA, and USB ports.

With a PC Mark 2005 score of 10,572, the Maximus Formula isn't bottlenecking the QX6850 (3.0 GHz) in any way. With a graphics score of 18,299 in 3D Mark 2005 (using an 8800GTX), this board is definitely free of the early hiccups that plague most platforms. We did get our E6550 (2.33 GHz) to run along happily at 3.15 GHz (the FSB being overclocked from a default 333 MHz to

450 MHz)—a very good result.

Rs 16,800 may seem high, but it's plenty of board for that much. ASUS includes a rich bundle too. Highly recommended for those looking at a high-end, stable platform in general, or CrossFire in particular.

Specifications

Intel X38 chipset; ICH9R Southbridge; DDR2 1200 MHz and 1600 MHz FSB support; 6 x rear USB ports; 6 x SATA 2.0 ports

Contact: Asustek Computer Inc
Phone: 022-67668800
E-mail: media_india@asus.com
Web site: <http://in.asus.com>
Price: Rs 16,800